Signet 01

Jim Hannon-Tan, 2026

Signet 01 is a silver signet ring. The square spiral cut into its face makes the entire object an antenna. Touched to a phone, the ring seals a written message with a mark that anyone can verify and no one can forge.

The signet

For five thousand years, a signet proved that a letter came from its sender. Now that any text can be generated in a person's name, Signet 01 restores the purpose of the signet.

How it works

1. **Write.** Write the words you want to stand behind.
2. **Touch.** Hold the ring to your phone. The phone powers the chip, and the ring signs.
3. **Share.** The seal is a permanent public record of the words, the signature and the time. Anyone with the link can check it.

What a seal proves

That this ring signed these exact words, and when. If one character changes, the seal no longer matches. The key that signs is made inside the ring and never leaves it.

The object

Cast in 925 sterling silver and finished by hand. The twelve-turn square spiral is the only break in the silver. The chip sits beneath it, behind a laser-welded closure. There is no battery. The phone powers the ring each time it signs.

The silver is made to be kept for decades. The studio can renew the electronics and refinish the silver.

©2026 · Adelaide, Australia

Founding Edition

Edition	Ten rings, numbered 01 to 10
Material	925 sterling silver, hallmarked
Price	US$10,000
First casting closes	15 December 2026
Delivery	From the first quarter of 2027

Specification

Reference	S01.AG
Antenna	12-turn square spiral, 13.56 MHz (NFC)
Chip	Arx HaLo secure element, passive, no battery
Key	Made on the chip. It cannot be exported
Record	Seals are recorded on LUKSO, a public ledger
Verification	Anyone can check a seal

The designer

Jim Hannon-Tan is an industrial designer based in Adelaide. He developed his practice in Melbourne, Milan, London and Amsterdam, and his work has been shown at the Triennale di Milano and the Tokyo National Museum.

Signet 01 follows Near Field Circuit (2025), ten brass objects each carrying an Arx chip linked to a digital record on LUKSO. All ten are held by collectors.

Makers

Industrial design	Jim Hannon-Tan
Casting	Morris & Watson, New Zealand
Bench work	Shannon Cornish Artisan Jewellers
Mechanical engineering	Varghese Liju
Electronic engineering	Aaron Mohtar
RF and antenna	Dr Shengjian Chen, Flinders University
Ledger and application	Aureliano Alarcón Smith
Photography	Isamu Sawa

Enquiries

Jim reads and answers every enquiry personally.

info@jimhannontan.com
www.hannontan.com

Status: the sealing application and the verification page are in development, for iPhone first. This monograph describes them as designed.

©2026 · Adelaide, Australia